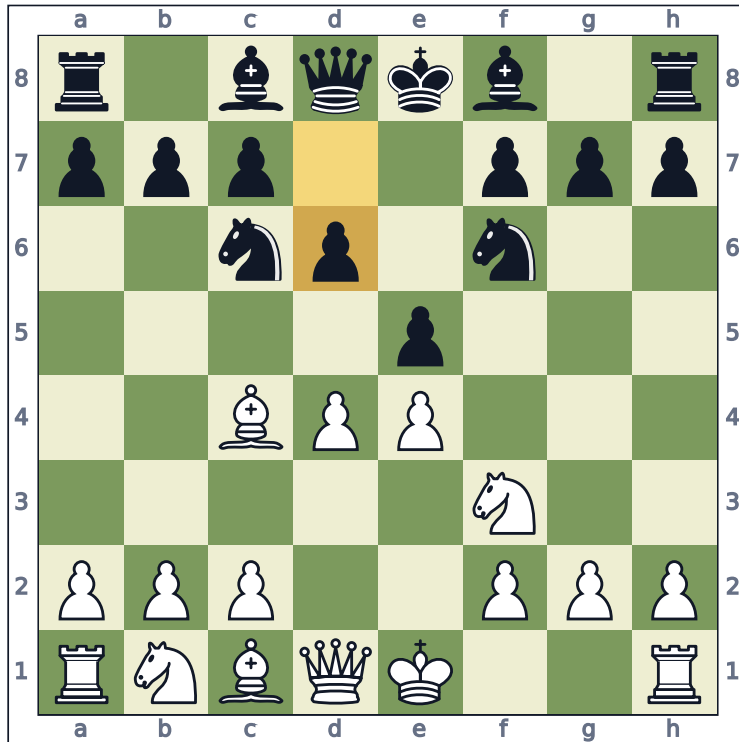


ITALIAN GAME, RUY LOPEZ, AND RELATED OPEN GAMES

Italian Game

ECO C56 | 24 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Risky for Black with best play. Use it only with concrete preparation or as a surprise weapon.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+1.39 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C56 covers Italian Game. White develops with pressure on e5 while Black builds a secure center and seeks the freeing ...d5 break. The diagram uses the featured line Italian Game: Scotch Invitation Declined.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 d6

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Castle, prepare d4, improve the least active piece, and preserve pressure rather than forcing tactics that are not ready.

BLACK'S GOALS

Defend e5 efficiently, challenge the center with ...d5, and use queenside or kingside activity according to White's structure.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

d4 and ...d5 define most transformations. c3 often supports d4; ...c5 may challenge a closed center.

PIECE MAP

The bishops on c4/b5 and c5/b4 shape development. Rooks become active on e- and d-files after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

The position can look quiet while tactical pressure accumulates on e5, f7, and along central files. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d6, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Elite, fully sound opening territory. It rewards patient improvement as much as concrete calculation.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C56 line

This section preserves all 24 names and defining routes assigned to C56 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. O-O

002 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, Anderssen Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. O-O Nxe4 6. Re1 d5 7. Bxd5 Qxd5 8. Nc3

003 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, Anderssen Attack, Main Line

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. O-O Nxe4 6. Re1 d5 7. Bxd5 Qxd5 8. Nc3 Qa5 9. Nxe4 Be6 10. Bd2 Qd5 11. Bg5

004 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, Canal Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. O-O Nxe4 6. Re1 d5 7. Nc3

005 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, Double Gambit Accepted

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. O-O Nxe4

006 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, Janowski Defense

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. O-O d6

007 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, Max Lange Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. O-O Bc5

008 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, Max Lange Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. e5 d5 6. Bb5 Ne4

009 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, Max Lange Attack Accepted

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. O-O Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. e5 d5 7. exf6 dxc4 8. Re1+ Be6 9. fxg7

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010 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, Max Lange Attack, Long Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. O-O Bc5 6. e5 d5 7. exf6 dxc4 8. Re1+ Be6 9. Ng5 Qd5 10. Nc3 Qf5 11. Nce4

011 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, Max Lange Attack, Spielmann Defense
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. O-O Bc5 6. e5 Ng4

012 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, Nakhmanson Gambit
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. O-O Nxe4 6. Nc3

013 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, Walbrodt-Baird Gambit
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. O-O

014 Italian Game: Scotch Gambit, de Riviere Defense
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7

015 Italian Game: Scotch Invitation Declined
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 d6

016 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Keidansky Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. e5 d5 6. Bb5 Ne4 7. Nxd4 Bc5 8. Nxc6 Bxf2+ 9. Kf1 Qh4

017 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Max Lange Attack
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. O-O Bc5 6. e5

018 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Max Lange Attack, Berger Variation
1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. O-O Bc5 6. e5 d5 7. exf6 dxc4 8. Re1+ Be6 9. Ng5 Qd5 10. Nc3 Qf5 11. g4 Qg6 12. Nce4 Bb6 13. f4 O-O-O

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019 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Max Lange Attack, Krause Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. O-O Bc5 6. e5 Ng4 7. c3

020 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Max Lange Attack, Loman Defense

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Bc5 5. O-O Nf6 6. e5 d5 7. exf6 dxc4 8. Re1+ Be6 9. Ng5 g6

021 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Max Lange Attack, Rubinstein Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. O-O Bc5 6. e5 d5 7. exf6 dxc4 8. Re1+ Be6 9. Ng5 Qd5 10. Nc3 Qf5 11. Nce4 Bf8

022 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Open Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4

023 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Perreux Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. Ng5

024 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Yurdansky Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 exd4 4. Bc4 Nf6 5. O-O Nxe4 6. Re1 d5 7. Bxd5 Qxd5 8. Nc3 Qa5 9. Nxe4 Be6 10. Bg5 h6 11. Bh4 g5 12. Nf6+ Ke7 13. b4